Joey Benitez III
01/02/2023
Jerome, Idaho

Collective Support for Free Education While Incarcerated

To whom it may concern,

My name is Joey and I would like to start off by telling you a little about myself. I am 29 years old, I graduated high school in 2012, and I am a father to my two wonderful children Jaidence Aurora Benitez and Jack Ezraiel Benitez. Unfortunately, I have lost significant time and precious moments due to my "criminal hiccups". Now, I am the only one to blame for the choices that I have made in my life. I take full responsibility for my actions and accept the consequences that come along with that statement. Being locked up is not fun for anyone obviously, but I feel like our correctional system can be improved. Not only for the benefit of the inmates but also the correctional staff, and eventually even the law-abiding citizens as well! Incarceration is like being on a "timeout" while all the "other kids" get to play outside! On a very serious note, educating ourselves and taking steps to ensure that we do not keep making the same mistakes over again is crucial and of the utmost importance! What can we do to increase the chances of success and decrease the odds of repeat offences? Free education for inmates is a topic that can no longer go overlooked or easily dismissed! Free education should not be thought of as a privelage, but it should instead be considered a right! A right that everyone should be entitled to. And it is so easy to make this a reality. Yes, there are GED classes and Treatment Programs; what about for the inmates doing time in county jails? What about the prison inmates who want to further their education or more intensive/personal treatment than what is being provided? Besides the obvious reasons free education will benefit here are some more things to think about.... TURN TO THE BACK OF THIS PAGE ⇒

Free education can give inmates something more useful to do with their time. In my experience, of being incarcerated, inmates are eager to learn and engage in extensive conversations with eachother on a frequent basis. Speaking, listening, giving feed back, and repeat; it is incredible to watch and be a part of! Giving inmates access to free educational tools and resources would boost morale and generate a positive, productive atmosphere. Correctional staff would appreciate having less negative energy and situations to deal with. And ultimately society would be thankful to accept us back being more educated and proactive about our lives. There is no reason why we should postpone making the necessary steps to making this dream come true! I have a vision of what our correctional system will become and with the right people to lead the way, it will not be too much longer!

THE FUTURE LOOKS BRIGHT!!!

Humbledy with all respect,

Joey Benitez

Joey Benitez

01/02/2023